

# YINGJIN SONG

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🌐 [LinkedIn](#)

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🔗 [yjsong22.github.io](https://yjsong22.github.io)

## Research Topics

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LLM, VLM, Agentic RL, Mechanistic Interpretability, Efficient, Reasoning, Benchmarking & Evaluation.

## Education

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**Utrecht University, Utrecht, the Netherlands**

**July 2022 – now**

*Ph.D. Candidate in Computer Science*

*Supervisor: Prof. Albert Gatt, Dr. Denis Paperno*

**The University of Melbourne, Melbourne, Australia**

**July 2019 – June 2021**

*Master of Computer Science (with Distinction)*

*Supervisor: Dr. Daniel Beck*

**The Australian National University, Canberra, Australia**

**July 2016 – June 2019**

*Bachelor of Information Technology*

## Publications

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- **Yingjin Song**, Denis Paperno and Albert Gatt (2026). Who Is Left of Whom? Tracing Spatial Evidence and Role Binding in Relative-Position Reasoning. In *AIW at COLM2026*. [link]
- **Yingjin Song**, Yupei Du, Denis Paperno and Albert Gatt (2025). Burn After Reading: Do Multimodal Large Language Models Truly Capture Order of Events in Image Sequences? In *Findings of ACL 2025*. [link]
- Yupei Du, **Yingjin Song**, Hugh Mee Wong, Daniil Ignatev, Albert Gatt and Dong Nguyen (2025). Disentangling the Roles of Representation and Selection in Data Pruning. In *Main Conference of ACL 2025*. [link]
- **Yingjin Song**, Denis Paperno and Albert Gatt (2024). Context-aware Visual Storytelling with Visual Prefix Tuning and Contrastive Learning. In *INLG 2024*. [link]
- **Yingjin Song** and Daniel Beck (2023). Modeling Emotion Dynamics in Song Lyrics with State Space Models. In *Transactions of the Association for Computational Linguistics (2023)*. [link]

## Service and Teaching

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- Reviewer of ACL Rolling Review (2024 - ), COLING (2024 - 2025), CoNLL (2025 -)
- Lecturer and TA of *Transformers: Applications in Language and Communication*: 2025 - 2026
- TA of *Methods in Artificial Intelligence Research*: 2022 - 2025
- TA of *Computational Thinking and Programming with Python*: 2023
- TA of *Responsible Data Science*: 2024 - 2025
- Daily supervisor for 8+ CS/AI BSc/MSc thesis students: 2023 - 2026

## Work Experience

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**Sina Weibo Corp.**

**December 2018 – February 2019**

*Data Science Intern*

*Beijing, China*

- \* Assisted in cleaning data, feature engineering, and utilizing ML models to optimize ad pricing strategies by predicting click-through and conversion rates.
- \* Developed an automated testing framework for migrating unit tests, ensuring ML pipeline compatibility, and designed a web page to visualize daily testing reports for stakeholders.

**Lenovo Group Ltd.**

**December 2016 – February 2017**

*Server Engineer Intern*

*Beijing, China*

- \* Assisted with engineers to maintain and solve issues in server clusters;
- \* Performed fault diagnosis and arranged on-site technicians and managed customers' data using SQL.